

Only keep what you use

Unwanted apps can often act as silent killers of our data privacy. Certain developers change the data requirements of their applications, and we don't even notice because we never cared to go back to the application after initially using it. To stop this from happening and also making sure that there is enough storage for those cute dog pictures on your phone, make sure that you delete all the apps that you haven't used for the last 10 days. This 10 days parameter is not universal but is a good place to start weeding out unwanted apps for most people.

Read the fine print

Whenever you are installing any application, even if it is on your PC, make sure you read the fine print. There is no need to go through all of it, but certain developers have dedicated privacy permissions listed out, which are definitely worth going through, while there are also some that try to sneak in certain shady consent requests, which even the most keen-eyed tend to miss out on. This will give you an idea about the possible nature of the app that you are installing. For example, an app that is there to let you control your TV through your phone should not need any permission to make phone calls and store and collect your message data. This is applicable not only for apps but also device-level permissions, which are asked for when you are setting up your phones for the first time, especially devices from certain Android manufacturers.

Keep your OS up to date

There is not much to say here. The latest version of operating systems always have fixes and patches that would do nothing but boost the performance and privacy of the phone. So, it is important to make sure that your phone's OS is always up to date. 